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# Youngstown and Ohio River Railroad

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One of the smaller interurban railways in the state of Ohio was the Youngstown and Ohio River Railroad, or Y&OR. Along with the [Youngstown and Southern Railway](#), the Y&OR formed a traction link between [Youngstown, Ohio](#) and the [Ohio River](#) at [East Liverpool](#). It served several [coal mines](#) in the area and was distinguished by the unusual feat of electrifying a section of a steam railroad, the [Pittsburgh, Lisbon and Western Railroad](#), as part of a [trackage rights](#) agreement. The Y&OR operated for 24 years.

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## History

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In 1906, a group of promoters formed the Y&OR for the purpose of completing an electric railway link between Youngstown and the Ohio River. Initially they leased the tracks of the Pittsburgh, Lisbon and Western (PL&W) between [Washingtonville](#) and [Salem](#) and strung trolley wire over the seven mile stretch of tracks. Construction began from Washingtonville and by 1907 service had been extended south to Lisbon. By 1909, the entire route from Salem to East Liverpool.

Passenger operations were conducted using a group of five interurban coaches and three combines ordered from [Niles Car and Manufacturing Company](#) in 1907. Freight trains were initially hauled by [steam locomotives](#) but in 1913 the Y&OR ordered [electric locomotives](#) to replace them. These "[steeplecabs](#)" were responsible for hauling the significant number of coal trains which traversed the Y&OR.

The decline of the Y&OR began in 1921 when the Youngstown and Southern Railway ceased purchasing its electric power from the Y&OR's [West Point power station](#). During the ensuing years of the 1920s the coal mines which provided much of the Y&OR's freight traffic began to play out and increasing use of [automobiles](#) eroded the line's passenger ridership. The company entered [receivership](#) in 1930 and all service was abandoned on March 9, 1931.

## Operations

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The Y&OR connected with three other interurban railways. It connected with the Youngstown and Southern Railway at [Leetonia](#), which provided a through route between Youngstown and East Liverpool, and it connected with the [Stark Electric Railroad](#) at Salem, on which passengers could ride west to [Canton](#) and a connection with the rest of the Indiana-Ohio interurban network. A third connecting line was the [Steubenville, East Liverpool and Beaver Valley Traction Company](#), which ran through East Liverpool along the Ohio River to [Steubenville](#) in the west and [Beaver, Pennsylvania](#).

## Rolling stock

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The passenger equipment of the Y&OR was unusually homogenous, with all eight cars having been built by the nearby Niles company in 1907. Cars 1-9 (odd numbers only) were 49' coaches with seating for 50, while cars 11, 13 and 15 were passenger-baggage combines of the same general design. Some former [New York City](#) elevated trailers were also owned for a time. All passenger rolling stock was [scrapped](#) following abandonment of the railroad.

Freight power consisted of three "steplecab" electric locomotives built by [Baldwin-Westinghouse](#), two dating to 1917 and the third to 1922. The three locomotives were sold, two to the [Union Electric Railway](#) of [Kansas](#) and one to the [Omaha, Lincoln and Beatrice Railway](#). One locomotive is now preserved at the [Ohio Railway Museum](#) while another is still in use on the [Iowa Traction Railroad](#).

Sources

[edit]

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